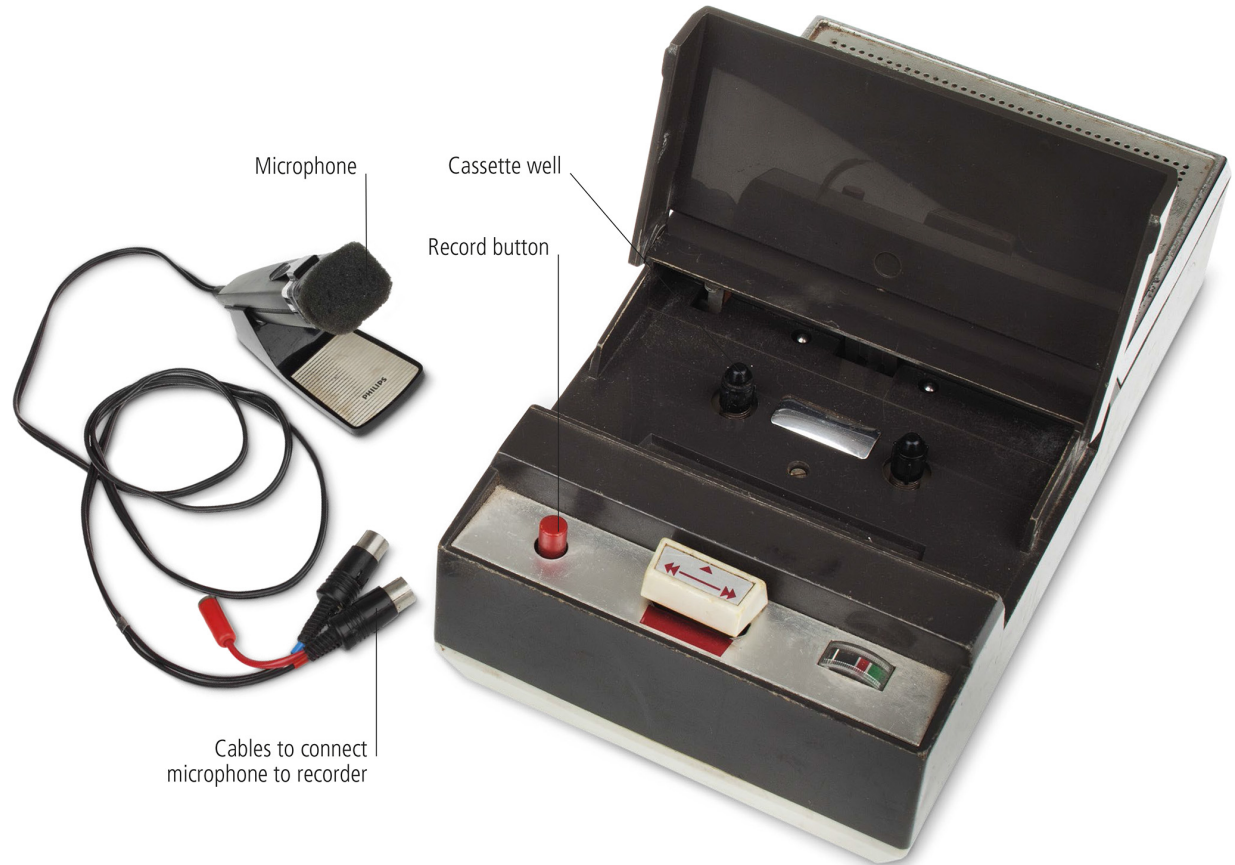


Unpopular strategy

In spite of this objective success, the battle sparked outcry in the US. The media painted a bleak picture of the battle. Senator Edward Kennedy labeled the engagement at Hamburger Hill “senseless and irresponsible.” War critics argued against continuing to endanger US troops in battles over territory that would not be held—and would likely return to enemy control soon after. It was difficult for those who were already against the war to appreciate the distinction Abrams made between denying the enemy a place and occupying that area.



Keeping record

This 1967 Philips portable tape recorder was used in the field in Vietnam. Battlefield reports heavily influenced US public opinion on Hamburger Hill, with one such report by Jay Sharbutt for the Associated Press bringing the name “Hamburger Hill” into American discourse.

» AFTER

Hamburger Hill, and the outrage it provoked, was the catalyst for a re-evaluation of US strategy.

TERRIBLE TOLL

Under pressure from the public and the Pentagon, General Abrams switched to a strategy of **protective reaction**, which would minimize US casualties. However, the damage was already done. *Life* magazine printed “The Faces of the American Dead in Vietnam: One Week’s Toll,” with portraits of **242 men killed** in a week. Many of them did not die at Hamburger Hill, but the public associated them with the battle nonetheless.